

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared in a local newspaper:

CCTV EVERYWHERE

CCTV surveillance cameras have become such a common feature of Hong Kong that we often don't notice them. But they notice you.

Many people are worried about the use of closed-circuit television and how it affects the privacy of individuals.

To test these concerns, we took a trip from Causeway Bay to Chek Lap Kok airport to find out how much we are being watched.

We counted at least 100 cameras during the 80-minute trip – a trip which involved visiting street-level shops and shopping malls and using several types of transport.

The government argue that CCTV reduces crime but there is no research on any direct links between a high use of CCTVs and a low crime rate.

Politicians and police seem to think it is a magic anti-crime system without saying exactly how it helps. CCTV is often a helpful tool in criminal investigations, but having cameras in public and private places does not necessarily prevent crime.

Why then does the Hospital Authority have 5,400 cameras at its public hospitals or the Legislative Council have 443 CCTV cameras outside? And how will these recordings be used?

Peaceful protesters worry about being arrested, criminals steal CCTV cameras to help them commit crimes, private investigators use CCTV to spy on cheating couples but the biggest worry is the lack of laws to regulate the use of CCTV in public or private areas.

Your school principal wants to introduce CCTV cameras to your school. Your class teacher wants you to discuss this topic. You may want to talk about:

- advantages of CCTV cameras
- disadvantages of CCTV cameras
- what rules there should be about the use of CCTV cameras in school
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you think CCTV is a good thing?
2. Do you worry about CCTV?
3. Do you think CCTV stops crime?
4. How will CCTV change in the future?
5. Are there some public places where there should be no CCTV?
6. Should people be worried about losing privacy?
7. Should CCTV recordings be shown on the news?
8. Is personal privacy more important than public security?